

Operations Runbook Template

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Effective Date: [YYYY-MM-DD]

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Version: [v01]

Owner: [Team/Department]

Approved by: [Name, Title]

Classification: [Internal Use Only / Confidential]

Purpose & Scope

[Brief description of what this runbook covers and what it does NOT cover. Include systems, applications, or processes in scope.]

When to Use This Runbook

- [Trigger condition or scenario #1]
- [Trigger condition or scenario #2]
- [Trigger condition or scenario #3]

When NOT to Use This Runbook

- [Exclusion scenario #1]
- [Exclusion scenario #2]

Prerequisites & Dependencies

Required Access & Permissions

- [System/Application]: [Role/Access Level Required]
- [System/Application]: [Role/Access Level Required]
- [Physical Access]: [Location/Badge Requirements]

Tools & Resources

- **Software:** [List specific tools, versions, and where to find them]
- **Hardware:** [List any required equipment]
- **Documentation:** [References to related runbooks, manuals, or diagrams]
- **Contacts:** [Key personnel and escalation paths]

Environmental Requirements

- [Time of day restrictions if applicable]
- [System maintenance windows]
- [Dependencies on other systems/processes]

Safety & Security Considerations

[!WARNING] [Critical safety warning or hazard if applicable]

[!CAUTION] [Important procedural caution]

[!NOTE] [Security classification or handling instructions]

Definitions & Acronyms

Term/Acronym	Definition
[ACRONYM]	[Full definition]
[TERM]	[Explanation]
[SYSTEM NAME]	[Brief description]

Procedure

[Numbered steps for executing the procedure. Each step should be actionable and verifiable.]

Phase 1: Preparation

1. **Verify Authorization:** Confirm approval has been obtained from [approver/system]
 - ☐ Check change management ticket #[#####]
 - ☐ Verify maintenance window approval
 - **Expected Outcome:** Authorization confirmed
 - **Falcon Green Checkpoint:** [Verification method]
2. **Environment Validation:** Ensure all prerequisite systems are available
 - ☐ System A: Responding to health checks
 - ☐ System B: Backup completed successfully
 - ☐ Network connectivity: Latency <50ms to [endpoint]
 - **Expected Outcome:** All systems green
 - **Falcon Green Checkpoint:** [Monitoring dashboard/view]

3. Backup & Rollback Preparation:

- ☐ Initiate pre-change backup of [system/component]
- ☐ Verify backup completion and integrity
- ☐ Document rollback procedure location: [link/path]
- **Expected Outcome:** Reliable restore point established
- **Falcon Green Checkpoint:** [Backup verification log]

Phase 2: Execution

4. Initiate Procedure:

- ☐ Execute command: `/scripts/pre-check.sh`
- ☐ Validate output: `EXPECTED: "ALL CLEAR"`
- ☐ Proceed only if pre-check passes
- **Expected Outcome:** System ready for changes
- **Falcon Green Checkpoint:** [Pre-check script output]

5. Primary Action Steps:

- ☐ Step 5.1: [Specific action with system/path]
 - Command: `specific-command --flag --value`
 - Verification: [How to confirm step completed]
 - **Falcon Orange Warning:** [If applicable - what to watch for]
- ☐ Step 5.2: [Next specific action]
 - [Verification method]
 - Expected time to complete: [X minutes]

6. Validation & Testing:

- ☐ Functional Test: [Describe test to perform]
 - Expected result: [Pass/Fail criteria]
 - Actual result: [To be filled during execution]
- ☐ Performance Test: [Load/response time test if applicable]
 - Baseline: [Previous known good]
 - Threshold: [Acceptable range]
- ☐ Security Test: [If applicable - access/authentication test]
 - Expected: [Authorized access only]
 - Actual: [To be filled]

Phase 3: Conclusion

7. System Restoration:

- ☐ Return systems to normal operating mode
- ☐ Disable any maintenance modes or bypasses
- ☐ Confirm all services listening on appropriate ports

8. Post-Procedure Verification:

- ☐ Health check all affected systems
- ☐ Validate business processes/functionality
- ☐ Confirm monitoring alerts are active and functioning

9. Documentation & Closure:

- ☐ Complete procedure log with timestamps
- ☐ Update change management ticket with outcome
- ☐ Notify stakeholders of completion
- ☐ Archive execution artifacts (logs, outputs, etc.)

Decision Points & Troubleshooting

[!IMPORTANT] At any decision point marked [!], follow the troubleshooting path if expected outcome is not achieved.

Decision Point 1: [!] Did pre-check script pass?

- **Yes:** Proceed to Step 5 (Primary Action Steps)
- **No:** See Troubleshooting Section A - Pre-check Failures

Decision Point 2: [!] Did primary action complete successfully?

- **Yes:** Proceed to Step 6 (Validation & Testing)
- **No:** See Troubleshooting Section B - Execution Failures

Decision Point 3: [!] Do validation tests pass?

- **Yes:** Proceed to Step 7 (System Restoration)
- **No:** See Troubleshooting Section C - Validation Failures

Troubleshooting Guide

Section A: Pre-check Failures

Symptom	Possible Cause	Diagnostic Action	Resolution
[Error message]	[Likely cause]	[Command to run/check]	[Steps to fix]
[Timeout/failure]	[Resource issue]	[Verification method]	[Resolution steps]

Symptom	Possible Cause	Diagnostic Action	Resolution
[Permission denied]	[Access issue]	[Check credentials/roles]	[Grant appropriate access]

Section B: Execution Failures

Symptom	Possible Cause	Diagnostic Action	Resolution
[Failure message]	[Software bug]	[Check logs at path]	[Apply patch/restart service]
[Resource exhausted]	[Capacity issue]	[Monitor CPU/Memory/Disk]	[Scale resources/cleanup]
[Connection refused]	[Network issue]	[Test connectivity to endpoint]	[Check firewall/routing]

Section C: Validation Failures

Symptom	Possible Cause	Diagnostic Action	Resolution
[Functionality broken]	[Configuration drift]	[Compare to known good config]	[Restore/reapply config]
[Performance degraded]	[Resource contention]	[Identify competing processes]	[Reschedule/restart services]
[Security alert triggered]	[False positive/legitimate]	[Investigate alert details]	[Adjust rule or investigate breach]

Rollback Procedure

[!WARNING] Only initiate rollback if directed by procedure owner or if system instability is detected.

Rollback Triggers

- ☐ Validation tests fail beyond acceptable thresholds
- ☐ System instability or cascading failures observed
- ☐ Explicit instruction from procedure owner or escalation contact

Rollback Steps

1. Initiate Rollback:

- ☐ Execute: `/scripts/rollback.sh [backup-timestamp]`
- ☐ Verify rollback initiation confirmation
- **Expected Outcome:** Rollback process started

2. Verify Rollback Completion:

- ☐ Check system services are running
- ☐ Confirm data integrity checks pass

- ☐ Validate business functionality restored
- **Expected Outcome:** Systems returned to pre-change state

3. Post-Rollback Actions:

- ☐ Document failure reason and resolution
- ☐ Update change management ticket with rollback outcome
- ☐ Conduct lessons learned meeting within [X] business days

References & Related Documents

- [Related Runbook: [Title] (ID: RB-YYYY-####)]
- [System Architecture Diagram: [link/path]]
- [Vendor Documentation: [title/link]]
- [Regulatory Reference: [regulation/standard]]
- [Previous Incidents: [INC-YYYY-####]]

Change History

Version	Date	Author	Description of Changes
v01	[YYYY-MM-DD]	[Author]	Initial release
v02	[YYYY-MM-DD]	[Author]	[Description of changes]

Follows Fly GACA Document Style Guide v1.2 Template: [tpl-ops-runbook.md](#) / Version: v01 / Last Updated: 2026-06-16 Review Required: Every [6] months or after significant system changes